

SPARTAN COACHING

DISCIPLINE | EMPATHY | STRATEGY

DECISION FRAMEWORKS

Strategic Tools for Field Sales Excellence

Account prioritization, objection response protocol, stage advancement criteria, weekly planning structure, and the referral readiness scoring model for Spartan-method practitioners.

Decision Frameworks

Tools for Making the Right Call in Every Situation

THE SPARTAN METHOD: FOUR-STAGE FRAMEWORK

The Spartan Healthcare Sales Mastery Model is not a linear checklist. It is a dynamic diagnostic tool. At any given moment in any given account, you are operating in one of four stages. The discipline is in knowing which stage you are in and resisting the temptation to skip ahead.

1

DISCOVERY

Learn about the account: census, operations, referral processes, decision-makers, and organizational challenges. Never move to Stage 2 without a clear picture of how the account works.

2

CONNECTING

Build individual rapport with your key contact. Learn their personal professional motivations, what success looks like to them, and what frustrates them about their current situation. This is where trust is built.

3

GUIDING

Align what you have learned in Stages 1 and 2 to what your hospice can provide. This is not a product presentation. It is a guided conversation where you help them see how your support solves their specific problems.

4

COMMITMENT

Ask for the referral or partnership clearly and confidently. You have earned the right to ask because you have done the work in the previous three stages. A weak close is almost always a sign that Stages 1 to 3 were incomplete.

ACCOUNT PRIORITIZATION MATRIX

Use this matrix to make clear decisions about where to invest your time. Review weekly and adjust as account behaviors change.

Priority	Characteristics	Time Allocation	Primary Stage Focus
A: Strategic	High potential, actively referred or near commitment	50% of call time	Stages 3 and 4
B: Developing	Good potential, relationship building in progress	30% of call time	Stages 1 and 2
C: Monitoring	Lower potential or high competitive barrier	20% of call time	Stage 1 maintenance

THE ACE OBJECTION RESPONSE PROTOCOL

Every objection you hear in the field can be handled with the ACE method. Master this three-step response and you will never be caught off guard.

1 Acknowledge

Show the other person that you heard them and that their concern is valid. Never argue, qualify, or start your response with "but." Examples: "That makes complete sense." / "I hear you." / "A lot of people in your position feel exactly the same way."

2 Clarify

Ask a question that helps you understand the root cause of the objection. The objection they state is often not the objection that is actually blocking the decision. Examples: "Help me understand what specifically feels like it is not the right fit." / "What would need to be different for this to make sense?"

3 Educate

Provide information that directly addresses the underlying concern. Use data, a case story, or a reframe. Never give a sales pitch in this moment. Give a specific, relevant answer to the specific concern they expressed.

STAGE ADVANCEMENT CRITERIA

Discovery to Connecting (Stage 1 to Stage 2)

- ☐ You can describe how the account's referral process works from identification to discharge
- ☐ You have identified the primary clinical challenges this account faces with their end-of-life population
- ☐ You know who the key decision-makers and influencers are and have met at least one
- ☐ You have had a conversation long enough to earn the right to a follow-up meeting

Connecting to Guiding (Stage 2 to Stage 3)

- ☐ Your key contact has shared a specific professional pain point, goal, or frustration
- ☐ You have delivered educational value that they have responded positively to
- ☐ You have built enough rapport that they are willing to share candid information about their situation
- ☐ They have expressed at least passive interest in understanding how your hospice works

Guiding to Commitment (Stage 3 to Stage 4)

- ☐ They have acknowledged that your approach addresses their specific challenges
- ☐ All major objections have been surfaced and addressed
- ☐ All relevant decision-makers have been engaged, not just the most accessible contact
- ☐ They have used language that implies forward movement: "that would be helpful," "let us try," "who would I contact?"

WEEKLY PLANNING FRAMEWORK

Monday: Planning and Preparation

- Review last week's call notes and identify any open commitments you made

- Confirm appointments and prioritize accounts to visit by tier
- Prepare educational resources and talking points for each planned visit
- Identify one new prospect account to add to your C Tier list

Tuesday through Thursday: High-Value Field Days

- Concentrate all in-person A and B Tier visits during these three days
- Target a minimum of 8 to 12 live conversations per day
- Send same-day follow-up emails for any meaningful conversations
- Document all visit notes in your CRM within 4 hours of each call

Friday: Follow-Up and Planning

- Complete any remaining CRM documentation from the week
- Review weekly activity totals against targets: conversations, referrals, admissions
- Identify which accounts advanced a stage and which stalled
- Begin territory planning for the following week
- Send one educational or follow-up email to a quiet account you have not visited recently

REFERRAL READINESS SCORING MODEL

Use this model to predict which accounts are most likely to refer in the next 30 days. Score each A and B Tier account monthly on these five factors, 1 to 5 each (5 = highest readiness):

- Relationship Depth: How strong is your relationship with the primary decision-maker?
- Stage Progression: Have you completed meaningful Discovery and Connecting work?
- Patient Volume Signal: Are there patients in this account who likely meet eligibility criteria right now?
- Competitive Weakness: Is there any dissatisfaction with the current hospice provider?
- Recent Engagement: Have they engaged with your educational content or follow-up recently?

Total score 20 to 25: Priority focus — a referral is likely within 30 days if you maintain contact frequency. Score 13 to 19: Active development — continue building relationship and education cadence. Score below 13: Stage reset may be needed — go back to genuine discovery.

FRAMEWORK DISCIPLINE

These frameworks are not theoretical tools. They are field instruments designed to help you make better decisions under the time pressure and unpredictability of real sales situations. The rep who has internalized these frameworks makes better decisions faster than one who is improvising. Drill them until they are instinct, not memory.